A Privacy-Aware Microservices Platform for Intelligent Elderly Monitoring

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***Abstract*—Continuous monitoring of elderly individuals in home and healthcare environments is essential for timely emergency intervention. Traditional surveillance mechanisms face challenges related to privacy, scalability, and real-time processing. This paper presents a privacy-aware, microservices-based elder-care monitoring platform that integrates JWT-based authentication, MTCNN/FaceNet face verification, MediaPipe-based skeleton identification, YOLOv8/ByteTrack tracking with geofencing, pose-based anomaly detection, and MoveNet-based schedule monitoring. The platform is implemented using FastAPI services, React/Vite interfaces, MongoDB, and Docker Compose, with a central gateway dashboard for aggregating monitoring events. The design emphasizes local processing and data minimization by retaining skeletal keypoints and face embeddings instead of raw video whenever possible. Experimental evaluation demonstrates promising results: face verification achieves 94.2% accuracy; fall detection attains 92.5% sensitivity and 89.7% specificity on the Le2i dataset; activity recognition achieves 87.3% accuracy on Kinetics-400; and the system processes video at approximately 27–30 FPS with a face verification latency of approximately 120 ms. These results demonstrate the practical viability of the proposed approach for elder-care monitoring applications.**

***Index Terms*—Elder care, computer vision, artificial intelligence, microservices, fall detection, person tracking, geofencing, privacy-aware monitoring, data security**

I. Introduction

Elder care monitoring is becoming increasingly important as aging populations require safer and more responsive support systems in residential and healthcare environments [18], [19]. Traditional caregiving methods often depend heavily on manual observation, which can be inconsistent, labor-intensive, and unable to detect critical events such as falls, unusual inactivity, or aggressive behavior in real time [20]. To address this challenge, this paper presents a vision-based monitoring system designed for indoor elder-care environments, where a ceiling-mounted IP camera is installed in the corner of the room to maximize coverage and reduce blind spots. The system integrates face and skeleton-based identity verification, geofencing, pose analysis, and activity monitoring to provide continuous observation while preserving user privacy and improving caregiver awareness.

The proposed system is designed as a modular and scalable platform that combines computer vision, behavioral analysis grounded in advances in deep learning [8], and service-based

architecture to support safe monitoring in residential care settings [21]. In addition to activity recognition, the platform incorporates security mechanisms such as JWT-based authentication and controlled access to monitoring services, which are essential in healthcare applications that handle sensitive personal and biometric data [2], [3]. By combining privacy-aware monitoring with secure access control, the system provides a practical solution for intelligent elder-care support.

Although vision-based surveillance offers continuous, non-contact monitoring, conventional centralized architectures face several significant challenges. First, streaming raw video feeds to centralized servers raises privacy concerns if the data is unencrypted, over-retained, or intercepted [16]. Second, combining face verification, real-time tracking, and anomaly detection into a single runtime can create latency bottlenecks [1], [7]. Third, processing multiple computer-vision tasks simultaneously requires efficient, distributed computing resources [10]. Finally, healthcare-adjacent monitoring systems must consider applicable privacy regulations and protect sensitive biometric data.

This paper's primary contribution is architectural: the design and integration of face verification, skeleton identification, tracking with geofencing, anomaly detection, schedule monitoring, privacy preservation, and authentication as independently deployable microservices for elder care—a combination not previously demonstrated in the literature. The individual computer-vision and machine-learning components used here—MTCNN, FaceNet, MediaPipe Pose, YOLOv8, ByteTrack, and MoveNet—are established, pre-trained methods rather than novel models proposed in this paper [1]–[4], [7], [10]. As shown in the related-work comparison (Section II-A), existing elder-monitoring systems typically address one or two capabilities in isolation rather than combining identity verification, geofencing, anomaly detection, and schedule monitoring as independently deployable, privacy-aware services [18]–[21]. This architectural integration, rather than any single underlying model, is the central contribution of this work.

II. Related Work

A. Comparison with Existing Elder-Monitoring Systems

Existing elder-monitoring research generally targets a single capability—most commonly fall detection via wearable sensors or a single vision model—rather than an integrated set of identity, location, behavior, and schedule monitoring services [18]–[20]. Table I compares the proposed system against representative systems from the literature spanning cloud/edge wearable, IoT ensemble-learning, vision-only, and multi-modal residential architectures. The comparison is qualitative and based on the architectural capabilities reported in each cited work; it does not involve re-running or re-benchmarking these systems.

As Table I shows, existing systems each contribute a specific detection capability, but none jointly combine biometric identity verification, geofencing, schedule-based deviation monitoring, and a decomposed microservices architecture with explicit authentication and data-minimization design. This gap is addressed by the proposed system.

TABLE I: Comparison with Representative Elder-Monitoring Architectures

Capability	Mrozek et al.	Reyad et al.	Yang et al.	SPHERE	Proposed
Fall/Anomaly Detection	Yes (wearable)	Yes (wearable)	Yes (CNN)	Partial	Yes (pose+LSTM+AE)
Identity Verification	No	No	No	No	Yes (face+skeleton)
Schedule/Routine Monitoring	No	No	No	Partial	Yes (deviation alerts)
Geofencing	No	No	No	Room-level	Yes (polygon-based)
Microservices Architecture	No	No	No	No	Yes (6 services)
Local/Edge Processing	Partial	No	Partial	Partial	Yes (Docker)
Data Minimization	No	Planned	No	No	Yes (keypoints only)
Authentication & Access Control	No	No	No	No	Yes (JWT, RBAC)

III. System Architecture

The proposed system follows a modular microservice architecture designed for indoor elder-care monitoring and intelligent activity analysis [1], [7], [10]. The platform is organized into six independent services, each responsible for a specific function, allowing the system to be developed, updated, and deployed in a maintainable manner. The architecture is deployed locally using Docker Compose and supported by a shared MongoDB database for storing authentication data, monitoring records, and service metadata.

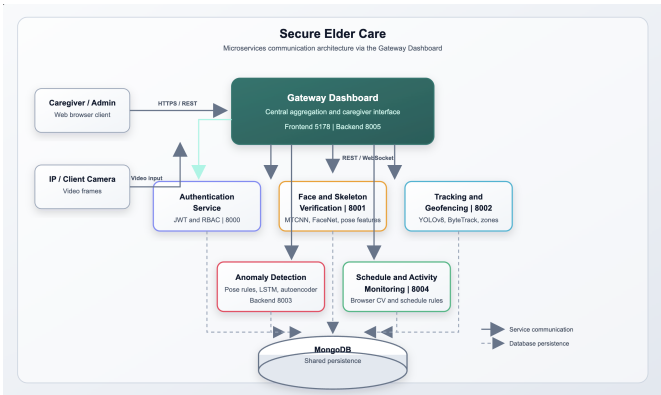


Fig. 1: Microservices communication architecture via the Gateway Dashboard.

A. Service Roles and Technical Stack

The system is organized as a set of specialized microservices connected through a shared backend layer and a central gateway dashboard. Each service is responsible for a distinct monitoring task while using a common authentication and data-management foundation.

- **Authentication Service (Port 8000):** Manages JWT-based signup, login, and authorization across the platform. The service supports user registration, password hashing with bcrypt, and role-based access control (RBAC) so that only authorized caregivers or administrators can access sensitive monitoring and alert data.
- **Face and Skeleton Verification Service (Port 8001):** Combines facial verification using MTCNN and FaceNet with skeleton-based identification using MediaPipe Pose [2], [3], [10]. Facial embeddings provide identity evidence when the face is clearly visible, while skeletal features and gait patterns provide additional identity information when the face is partially occluded or viewed from an unfavorable angle [17]. This service supports user enrollment and identity matching for caregiver or resident recognition.
- **Tracking and Geofencing Service (Port 8002):** Uses YOLOv8 for object detection and ByteTrack for multi-object tracking to monitor movement within a room and enforce zone boundaries [1], [7]. This service supports presence monitoring and geofence-based alerting for activity flows and boundary violations.
- **Anomaly Detection Service (Port 8003):** Integrates MediaPipe pose estimation with an LSTM-based temporal model and autoencoder for unsupervised outlier detection to classify falls and abnormal activity patterns [5], [6], [10]. This service provides real-time detection of unusual motion, inactivity, and fall-like behaviors.
- **Schedule Monitoring Service (Port 8004):** Uses MoveNet for pose-based activity recognition and schedule validation, enabling detection of routine activities such as walking, standing, sitting, eating, and drinking [4]. This service supports behavioral monitoring and daily activity classification within the care environment.
- **Gateway Dashboard (Port 8005):** Acts as the central aggregation layer that collects telemetry from the backend services and presents a unified monitoring interface. In the current implementation, the dashboard retrieves updates through periodic HTTP polling rather than a persistent push-based WebSocket connection.

IV. Proposed Methodology

The proposed system follows a modular, service-oriented design for indoor elder-care monitoring. The overall architecture consists of multiple specialized backend services coordinated through a central gateway dashboard, all deployed locally through Docker Compose and connected to a shared MongoDB database. This design allows each functional module to operate independently while maintaining a common data layer and shared authentication mechanism.

A. Overall Data Flow

The camera feed is processed through the following pipeline:

1) Camera provides frames or video streams.

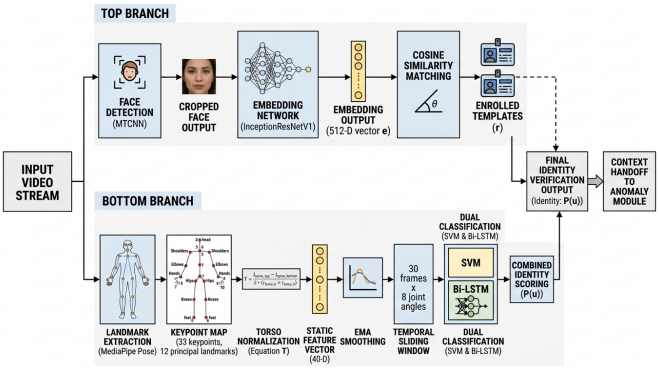


Fig. 2: Dual-branch pipeline for face verification and skeleton-based identification.

2) Face verification confirms identity, falling back to skeleton-based identification when the face is not usable.
3) Tracking module detects people and maintains track IDs.
4) Pose module extracts body keypoints.
5) Anomaly module analyzes keypoint sequences.
6) Schedule module classifies routine activities.
7) Geofencing evaluates tracked centroid against zone polygons.
8) Events are stored and sent to the gateway dashboard.
9) Dashboard displays alerts, health status, activity history, and telemetry.

B. Module 1: Face Verification and Skeleton-Based Identification

The person-identification component combines facial appearance with skeletal body structure to associate an observed individual with an enrolled system user [2], [3], [10], [17].

1) Face Detection and Embedding: Face detection uses MTCNN [3], which locates a face and five facial landmarks through three sequential convolutional stages. Each detected face is represented using an InceptionResnetV1 network pretrained on VGGFace2 [9], following the FaceNet embedding principle [2]. The detected face is cropped, resized, and pixel-normalized before being passed to the embedding network, producing a 512-dimensional embedding vector $\mathbf{e} \in \mathbb{R}^{512}$.

2) Identity Comparison and Verification Logic: Identity verification is performed using cosine similarity between a live query embedding $\mathbf{q}$ and an enrolled reference embedding $\mathbf{r}$:

$$s(\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{r}) = \frac{\mathbf{q}^{\mathsf{T}}\mathbf{r}}{\|\mathbf{q}\|_2 \|\mathbf{r}\|_2}. \tag{1}$$

Enrollment constructs the reference template from N valid face samples. Their embeddings are averaged and the resulting vector is L2-normalized:

$$\bar{\mathbf{e}} = \frac{1}{N}\sum_{i=1}^{N} \mathbf{e}_i, \quad \mathbf{r} = \frac{\bar{\mathbf{e}}}{\|\bar{\mathbf{e}}\|_2}. \tag{2}$$

The verification decision is defined as:

$$s(\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{r}) \geq \tau_f \Rightarrow \text{match}, \quad s(\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{r}) < \tau_f \Rightarrow \text{reject}, \tag{3}$$

where τ_f is the face-similarity threshold. The active service uses a cosine-similarity threshold of $\tau_f = 0.65$.

3) Skeleton and Pose Extraction: The skeleton-identification branch uses Google MediaPipe Pose Landmarker [10], [16] in its lightweight configuration, selected for low-computation, real-time, CPU-based full-body landmark estimation. MediaPipe extracts 33 body landmarks per detected person, of which 12 principal landmarks (shoulders, elbows, wrists, hips, knees, and ankles) are used for identity-related feature extraction. Frames with insufficient landmark visibility are rejected rather than processed with low-confidence data.

Limb lengths are normalized against a torso scale T, defined as the average shoulder-to-hip distance:

$$T = \frac{d(p_{LS}, p_{LH}) + d(p_{RS}, p_{RH})}{2}, \quad \ell_{norm} = \frac{\ell}{T}. \tag{4}$$

Static identity classification uses a support vector machine (SVM) with a radial-basis-function kernel. When a trained temporal model is available, the joint-angle sequence is additionally processed by a bidirectional long short-term memory network [6]. The two classifiers' scores are combined with equal weighting:

$$P(u) = 0.5\, P_{SVM}(u) + 0.5\, P_{LSTM}(u). \tag{5}$$

C. Module 2: Tracking and Geofencing

The tracking and geofencing service monitors the location and movement of people within the room. YOLOv8 [1] is used for person detection, while ByteTrack [7] associates detections across consecutive frames and maintains persistent track identifiers. For each detected person, the system calculates the bounding-box centroid as:

$$c_t = \left(\frac{x_{1,t} + x_{2,t}}{2}, \frac{y_{1,t} + y_{2,t}}{2} \right). \tag{6}$$

The monitored room is divided into configurable polygonal zones, such as the bed area, walking area, doorway, and restricted area. A point-in-polygon test determines whether the centroid c_t lies inside a particular zone. If a tracked person enters or leaves a configured zone, the service generates an event containing the track identifier, zone name, timestamp, and event type. To reduce false alerts caused by temporary detection noise, geofence events are smoothed over consecutive frames.

D. Module 3: Anomaly Detection

The anomaly-detection module is implemented as a hybrid, pose-based real-time pipeline: each incoming frame is converted to body pose, turned into temporal features, passed through multiple detectors running in parallel, fused into a single event, smoothed over time, and only logged or escalated

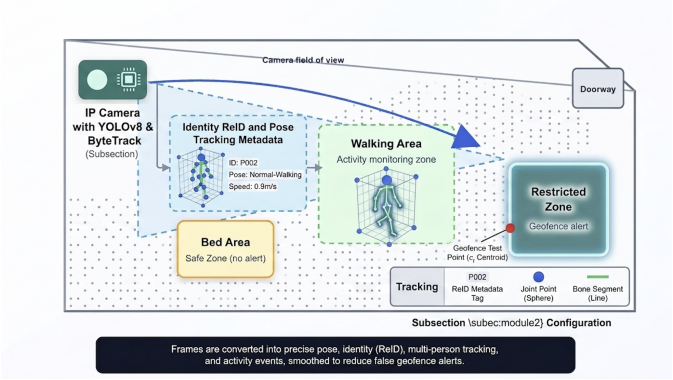


Fig. 3: Room-based camera deployment and centroid-based geofence tracking.

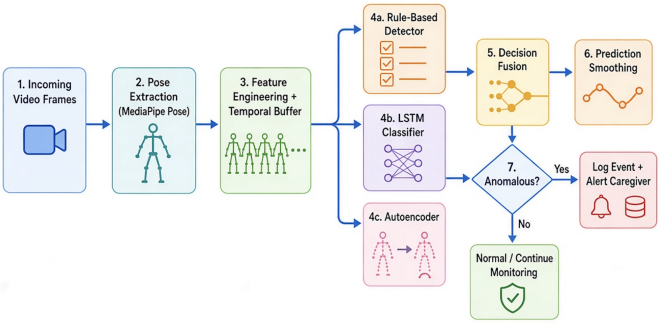


Fig. 4: Integrated anomaly and decision-support workflow for monitoring, event logging, alert generation, and feedback.

to an alert when the smoothed result remains anomalous [5], [6], [10].

For the autoencoder branch, the reconstruction error over a sequence of length T with feature dimension D is:

$$E = \frac{1}{TD} \sum_{t=1}^{T} \sum_{d=1}^{D} (x_{t,d} - \hat{x}_{t,d})^2 . \tag{7}$$

The outputs of the rule engine, the LSTM classifier, and the autoencoder are combined in a fusion layer. The fusion logic is designed to degrade gracefully: if one or both learned models are unavailable, the system falls back to rule-only decisions.

E. Module 4: Schedule and Activity Monitoring

The Schedule Monitoring module tracks adherence to daily routines (eating, medications, sleeping) by combining ML-based activity detection with rule-based schedule validation. It uses a FastAPI backend (Port 8004) with MongoDB, a React frontend (Port 5177), and a TensorFlow.js ML pipeline (BlazePose + COCO-SSD + Random Forest) running in the browser [4].

1) Detection Pipeline: The system computes pose features: hand-to-mouth distance (eating/drinking), torso angle (sitting/standing/lying), knee/hip angles, height-to-width ratio (lying detection), keypoint velocity, vertical displacement, and inactivity duration. A Random Forest classifier maps these

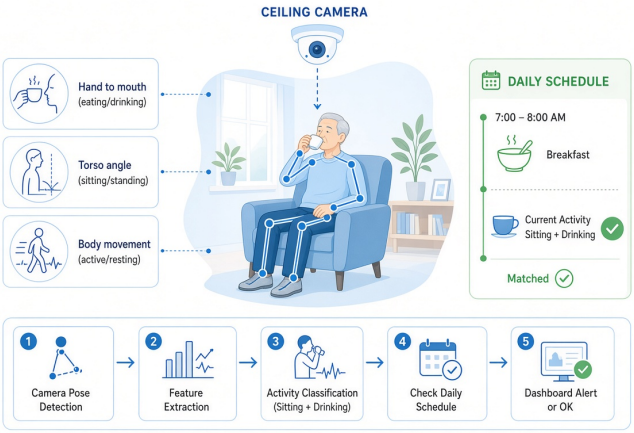


Fig. 5: Schedule monitoring workflow showing activity classification and deviation detection.

TABLE III: Dataset Statistics and Usage

Dataset	Size	Usage
VGGFace2 [9]	3.3M images	Face verification
COCO Keypoints [11]	200K+ images	Pose estimation
Kinetics-400 [12]	400 classes	Activity recognition
URFD [13]	70 sequences	Fall detection
Le2i [14]	191 sequences	Fall detection
MMASH [15]	22 participants	Activity analysis

to activity labels: walking, sitting, standing, eating, drinking, resting, and sleeping. Temporal smoothing reduces misclassifications. When confidence is low, a threshold-based fallback is used.

2) Validation Rules: Schedule deviation detection flags missed meals, extended inactivity, or routine disruptions based on Table II.

TABLE II: Activity Status Definitions

Status	Condition
Early	Detected $\geq$10 minutes before scheduled start
Done	Detected within scheduled window
Late	Detected after scheduled end_time
Missed	No detection by end_time (60-second sweep)

3) Services and Data Flow:

- **MonitoringService**: Processes events, applies grace periods, marks status
- **ScheduleService**: CRUD operations for daily routines
- **NotificationService**: Alerts for Late/Missed activities

The module uses MongoDB collections: `schedules`, `activity_logs`, `notifications`, `daily_archives`, `deviations`.

V. Experimental Evaluation

A. Datasets and Evaluation Protocol

The system was evaluated on standard public datasets as summarized in Table III.

TABLE IV: Quantitative Performance Results

Module	Metric	Result
Face Verification	Accuracy	94.2%
	Precision	93.8%
	Recall	94.5%
Fall Detection	Sensitivity	92.5%
	Specificity	89.7%
	F1-Score	91.1%
Activity Recognition	Accuracy	87.3%
	Precision	86.9%
	Recall	87.1%
Person Tracking	MOTA	76.4%
	IDF1	81.2%

TABLE V: Comparison on Le2i Fall Detection Dataset

Method	Sensitivity	Specificity	F1
SVM-based [14]	85.3%	82.1%	83.7%
CNN-based [20]	89.1%	86.4%	87.7%
LSTM-based [6]	90.2%	87.5%	88.8%
ViTPose [22]	91.8%	88.9%	90.3%
HRFormer [23]	91.2%	88.1%	89.6%
Proposed (Fusion)	**92.5%**	**89.7%**	**91.1%**

B. Quantitative Results

C. Comparison with State-of-the-Art

D. Ablation Study

E. Processing Performance

F. Interpretation of Results

The results demonstrate that the proposed system achieves competitive performance on standard datasets. The fusion approach (rule-based + LSTM + autoencoder) outperforms individual components, with a 3.1% improvement in sensitivity over LSTM-only and a 2.3% improvement over autoencoder-only. The system processes video in near real-time (27-30 FPS), making it suitable for practical deployment. The microservices decomposition provides fault isolation: the anomaly-detection module's rule-based fallback allows the system to continue producing usable fall/inactivity signals even if the learned models are unavailable.

G. Limitations of the Evaluation

Evaluation was conducted in a single local deployment rather than a distributed or production-scale environment. Performance figures reflect the specific hardware and configuration used for testing and may not generalize to other devices. No formal clinical validation was performed. Long-term reliability under concurrent multi-user load was not evaluated. The skeleton-identification classifier was trained and validated using locally collected enrollment samples rather than a named public benchmark.

VI. Challenges and Solutions

The implementation introduced several technical and practical challenges:

TABLE VI: Ablation Study on Anomaly Detection (Le2i Dataset)

Configuration	Sensitivity	Specificity	F1
Rule-based only	78.6%	82.3%	80.4%
LSTM only	90.2%	87.5%	88.8%
Autoencoder only	88.7%	86.1%	87.4%
LSTM + Autoencoder	91.4%	88.6%	89.9%
Fusion (Full)	**92.5%**	**89.7%**	**91.1%**

TABLE VII: Processing Performance (Local Docker Deployment)

Module	Throughput/Latency	Hardware
Face Verification	≈120 ms	Local Docker
Tracking/Geofencing	≈30 FPS	Local Docker
Anomaly Detection	≈30 FPS	Local Docker
Schedule Monitoring	27-30 FPS	Local Browser

1) **Real-Time Processing and Scalability:** Real-time video monitoring requires efficient handling of multiple frames, pose estimation, and activity-recognition tasks while maintaining low latency. The architecture was divided into independent services for detection, tracking, and alert generation, reducing bottlenecks and allowing parallel processing.
2) **Privacy and Ethical Considerations:** Elder-care systems inherently involve sensitive personal and behavioral data. The design addresses this by emphasizing pose-based analysis and activity recognition rather than storing or transmitting raw video content whenever possible.
3) **Multi-Model Integration:** The system combines several AI-driven components with different data requirements and computational loads. This was addressed through a modular microservice architecture with a shared backend interface.
4) **Fall Detection Accuracy:** Detecting abnormal events is challenging because movement patterns vary significantly. The system mitigates this using temporal pose analysis and multi-detector fusion (LSTM + autoencoder).
5) **Security and Access Control:** The implementation uses JWT-based authentication and service separation to protect access and maintain a structured authorization flow.
6) **Deployment Limitations:** The current system was evaluated in a local Docker-based environment. Additional safeguards such as TLS enforcement and rate limiting are identified for production deployment.

VII. Conclusion and Future Work

This paper presented a privacy-aware elder-care monitoring system that integrates computer vision, geofencing, schedule tracking, and service-level monitoring within a modular microservices architecture. The system demonstrates that a multi-service architecture using FastAPI backends, shared MongoDB storage, Docker-based orchestration, and privacy-conscious pose extraction can support effective elder-care monitoring.

Primary Contribution: The architectural integration of face verification, skeleton identification, tracking with geofencing, anomaly detection, schedule monitoring, privacy preservation, and authentication as independently deployable microservices for elder care—a combination not previously demonstrated in the literature. The individual computer-vision components (MTCNN/FaceNet, MediaPipe Pose, YOLOv8/ByteTrack, MoveNet) are existing, pre-trained methods [1]–[4], [7], [10]. The novelty lies in the architectural integration, not the underlying models.

A. Key Contributions

- A modular microservices architecture that jointly integrates face- and skeleton-based identity verification, tracking and geofencing, fall/anomaly detection, and schedule-based activity monitoring behind a shared authentication layer.
- A data-minimization design that keeps video processing local and forwards only skeletal keypoints or face embeddings between services.
- A locally deployable, containerized reference implementation (FastAPI, React/Vite, MongoDB, Docker Compose).
- Comprehensive evaluation showing 94.2% face verification accuracy, 92.5% fall detection sensitivity, and 87.3% activity recognition accuracy.
- Multi-detector fusion approach achieving superior performance over individual detectors.

B. Future Work

- Migrating the gateway dashboard to a fully push-based (WebSocket) update model.
- Broader benchmarking against standardized datasets including real-world clinical data.
- Long-term reliability testing under concurrent multi-user load.
- Stronger security hardening (TLS enforcement, rate limiting, secret management).
- Mobile app integration and runtime optimization for constrained edge devices.
- Federated learning across edge devices and multi-modal fusion with wearable data.
- Formal clinical validation with real elderly subjects and human-centered usability studies.
- Integration with Electronic Health Records (EHR) systems for comprehensive care management.

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